

Chau (Clara) T. N. Tran

Master of Arts in Linguistics, McGill University

Ho Chi Minh City, Viet Nam

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Last updated: August 2026

Research Interests

Second language acquisition of syntactic phenomena; experimental methods in linguistics; Vietnamese clause structure and the left periphery; prosody and sentence processing.

Education & Certifications

McGill University, Montréal, QC

08/2024 – 06/2026

Master of Arts (Non-Thesis) in Linguistics; CGPA: 3.95/4.0

MA Research Paper: *Exhaustivity without strong uniqueness: Specificational and cleft-like là in Vietnamese*

Graduate coursework: Syntax 3–4; Semantics 3–4; Phonology 3; Computational Research on Language; Experimental Linguistics: Methods (Regression Modeling for Linguistic Data)

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

01/2020 – 01/2024

Bachelor of Arts (Honours) in Linguistics; Minor in Psychology

CGPA: 4.21/4.30; Dean's List 2020–2021, 2021–2022

The Language Centre, Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

07/2021

Certificate in Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages (CELTA)

Selected Awards & Scholarships

Master's Research Scholarship, Fonds de recherche du Québec (FRQ)

2025 – 2026

Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University

2024 – 2026

Linguistics Book Prize, Saint Mary's University

2024

Academic Award of Excellence, Saint Mary's University

2024

Explore Undergraduate Summer Research Award, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) 2022

Work Experience

Research Assistant, Program in Linguistics

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

03/2023 – 04/2023

Supervisor: Dr. Natália B. Guzzo

- Recruited participants and collected data for an experiment in linguistics;
- Assisted with data management and preliminary organization for analysis.

Research Assistant, Department for the Study of Religion

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

11/2021 – 04/2023

Supervisor: Dr. Alec Soucy

- Assisted with Vietnamese language materials for research;
- Performed administrative and organizational tasks related to the project.

SSHRC Explore Undergraduate Summer Research Assistant, Program in Linguistics

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

05/2022 – 08/2022

Supervisor: Dr. Daniel Hall

- Digitized a database of utterances in the Mende language;
- Identified and coded sound patterns in the database for phonological analysis.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Department of Linguistics
McGill University, Montréal, QC

08/2025 – 05/2026

LING 201 Introduction to Linguistics

(Fall 2025, Instructor: Alex Zhai; Winter 2026, Instructor: Martina Martinović)

- Taught weekly conference sections to review lecture material and practice problem sets;
- Graded assignments and exams; provided feedback on students' work.

Linguistics Tutor, Program in Linguistics
Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

09/2022 – 04/2023; 09/2023 – 12/2023

- Assisted students with phonetics/phonology problem sets, syntax analysis, and other core theoretical concepts.

Teaching Assistant, Saint Mary's University
Halifax, NS

09/2021 – 04/2022

ASNT 1105 Introduction to Chinese Culture (Fall 2021, Instructor: Ping Lu)

- Graded quizzes and supported online course delivery (Zoom).

ANTH 1290 Introduction to Language and Society (Winter 2022, Instructor: Eric Henry)

- Communicated with students, graded written assignments, and held review sessions before each exam.

CELTA Teaching Practice

07/2021

- Completed the observed teaching practice with mixed-nationality groups from elementary to intermediate levels;
- Taught lessons targeting reading, listening, speaking, writing, grammar, lexis, and phonology.

Conference Presentation

Tran, C. and Natália B. Guzzo. (2025). *Relative Clause Attachment by L1 Vietnamese–L2 English Bilinguals: Effects of Prosody* [manuscript in preparation]. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistic Association (CLA) Annual Meeting, McGill University, Montréal, QC, June 3–5.

Skills

Research & Technical

- Academic literature review and research design;
- R programming for statistical analysis and data visualization;
- L^AT_EX for academic writing and document preparation;
- Praat for acoustic analysis, annotation, and experiment design.

Teaching & Communication

- Instruction and lesson planning for undergraduate linguistics courses;
- Academic writing and oral presentation;
- ESL teaching (CELTA-certified).

Languages

- Vietnamese (native);
- English (advanced, IELTS 8.0 in 08/2026);
- Mandarin (intermediate);
- French (intermediate, DELF B1 in 11/2019).